Implementing virtual onboarding programs for newcomers in corporate settings

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PICO & keywords

P	**New employees/interns**
I	Implementation of **virtual onboarding**
C	**Corporate settings**
O	Implications for the **new employees**

Research question: *What are the consequences of implementing virtual onboarding for new employees in corporate settings?*

Motivation: Onboarding is important for helping new hires to understand their workplace, role and organizational culture.

Selection criteria, database choice & why?

INCLUDE: all companies, new employees/hires, interns, 2018-2026, english language, peer reviewed articles

EXCLUDE: students, visitors, less than 10 citations

TITLE-ABS-KEY (("virtual onboarding" OR "digital onboarding" OR "e-onboarding" OR "virtual training" OR "digital training" OR "online training" OR "remote onboarding") AND ("new employee*" OR "new hire*" OR "newcomer*" OR "onboardee*") AND (compan* OR organization* OR organisation* OR firm* OR enterpris* OR workplace*))

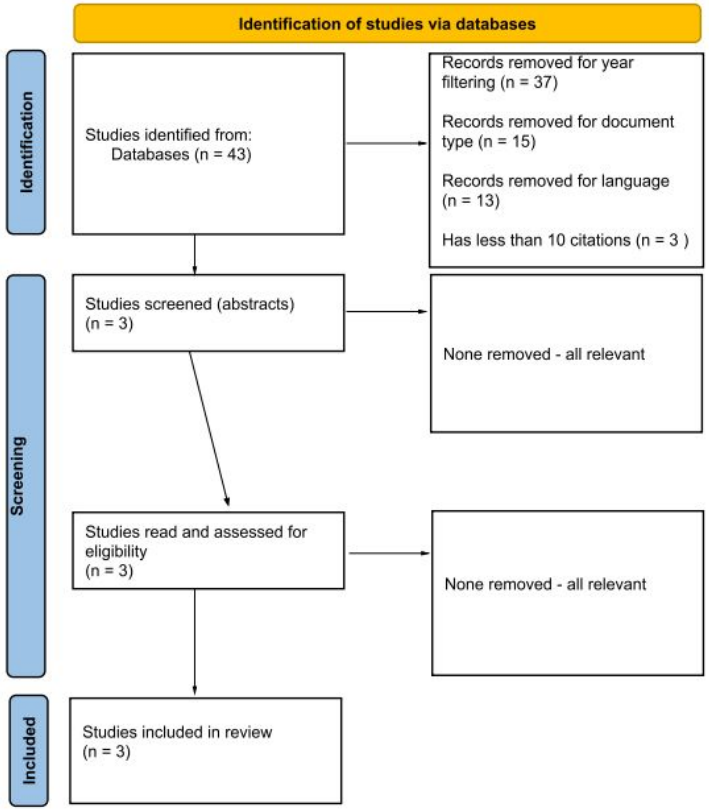
DATABASE:

Scopus: It has a variety of articles from various subject areas and was highly recommended for a broad search

What happened during search?

- Went to Scopus and entered our keywords via search string
- Started narrowing down the search using our selection criteria while filling in Prisma
- Made some changes as we went - initially “tech companies”, we broadened search, initially focused on “autonomy” of new employee, removed that and focused just on implication

PRISMA Flow Diagram



Themes & summary

Challenges: Any text describing difficulties or unintended negative consequences resulting from digital onboarding

Solutions: Actionable strategies recommended to fix digital onboarding problems

Short Summary (how themes generated answers research questions):

- *What are the consequences of implementing virtual onboarding for new employees in corporate settings?*

Challenges: Social isolation, unclear and undetailed communication, difficult to develop shared values, skills, attitudes, knowledge, abilities, behaviors and relationships, workplace bullying

Solution: Hybrid approach, virtual mentoring programs, social media for informal peer to peer communications, new employees should acquire digital skills, receive regular feedback

Simplified thematic analysis of the included studies

Year	Author(s)	Title	Purpose (or research questions)	Theoretical framework	Method	Findings
2023	Sani K.F., Adisa T.A., Adekoya O.D., Oruh E.S.	Digital onboarding and employee outcomes: empirical evidence from the UK	Explores the impact of digital onboarding on employees' wellbeing, engagement level, performance, and overall outcomes	Organizational Socialization Theory	Interpretive qualitative research methodology, semi-structured interviews, snowball sampling, thematic analysis	Employees are exposed to both the positive and negative impacts of digital onboarding. On a positive note, findings show that digital onboarding relatively reduces hostility in the workplace, including bullying, harassment, and intimidation, particularly in the views of employees who perceive that digital onboarding accommodates introverted personalities. In terms of the negative impacts of digital onboarding, our study found that digital onboarding results in social disconnection at work, diminishes meaningful work, decreases transparency, and increases mistrust issues at work
2023	Yarbrough J.W. ,Ramos Salazar L.	Virtual onboarding and socialization, an exploration of employee discussions and experiences	Compares online commentaries in relation to current research findings to determine a functional description of effective virtual onboarding (VO)	Organizational socialization	Qualitative, inductive thematic analysis, explored new employees' online, anonymous, public commentary about the employers' VO experiences	The new hires want clear, detailed communication about their VO process. Some remotely onboarded employees describe negative experiences in which they formed no professional connections and received no job-related preparations. Some of the remote hires shared that it was challenging to understand organizational values in their remote hiring process. In all three instances, the participants are seeking improved virtual communication channels between themselves, their managers and their colleagues.
2022	Petrilli S. ,Galuppo L. ,Ripamonti S.C.	Digital Onboarding: Facilitators and Barriers to Improve Worker Experience	Understand how the onboarding process is experienced, and to what extent it reveals itself as a "Sustainable Human Resource practice", triggering not only newcomers' socialization, but also their flourishing and resilient grow.	Organizational Socialization Theory	Qualitative approach, where interns documented and reflected on their own digital onboarding experiences using ethnographic sheets.	Digital onboarding made it harder for newcomers to **understand their role, build relationships, receive feedback, and understand the organizational culture**. Clear information, social support, and regular feedback were identified as important facilitators.

Why do you think virtual onboarding is important for newcomers?



References

Petrilli, S., Galuppo, L., & Ripamonti, S. C. (2022). Digital Onboarding: Facilitators and Barriers to Improve Worker Experience. *Sustainability*, *14*(9). https://doi.org/10.3390/su14095684

Sani, K. F., Adisa, T. A., Adekoya, O. D., & Oruh, E. S. (2022). Digital Onboarding and Employee outcomes: Empirical Evidence From the UK. *Management Decision*, *61*(3), 637–654. https://doi.org/10.1108/MD-11-2021-1528

Yarbrough, J. W., & Ramos Salazar, L. (2023). Virtual onboarding and socialization, an exploration of employee discussions and experiences. *Corporate Communications: An International Journal*, *28*(5). https://doi.org/10.1108/ccij-12-2022-0158